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September 16, 1976

FEDERAL SPECIFICATION

PILLOW, BED (LATEX FOAM AND FIBERFILL)

This specification was approved by the Commissioner, Federal Supply Service, General Services Administration, for the use of all Federal agencies.

1. SCOPE

1.1 Scope. This specification covers one type and one size of latex enveloped fiberfill cushion wrap or equivalent bed pillow.

2. APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 The following documents, of the issues in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal, form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein.

Federal Specifications:

L-P-378 - Plastic Sheet and Strip, Thin Gauge, Polyolefin.
V-F-106 - Fasteners, Slide, Interlocking.
V-T-276 - Thread Cotton.
CCC-C-432 - Cloth, Sheeting, Cotton (Unbleached, bleached, and dyed).
DDD-L-20 - Label; for Clothing, Equipage, and Tentage, (General Use).
PPP-B-636 - Box, Shipping, Fiberboard.

Federal Standards:

Fed. Std. No. 123 - Marking for Shipment (Civil Agencies).
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 191 - Textile Test Methods.
Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601 - Rubber; Sampling and Testing.
Fed. Std. No. 751 - Stitches, Seams and Stitchings.

(Activities outside the Federal Government may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks as outlined under General Information in the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards and at the prices indicated in the Index. The Index, which includes cumulative monthly supplements as issued, is for sale on a subscription basis by the Superintendent of Documents, U.S. Government Printing Office, Washington, DC 20402.

(Single copies of this specification and other Federal Specifications required by activities outside the Federal Government for bidding purposes are available without charge from Business Service Centers at the General Services Administration Regional Offices in Boston, New York, Washington, DC, Atlanta, Chicago, Kansas City, MO, Fort Worth, Denver, San Francisco, Los Angeles, and Seattle, WA.

(Federal Government activities may obtain copies of Federal Specifications, Standards, and Handbooks and the Index of Federal Specifications and Standards from established distribution points in their agencies.)

Military Standards:

MIL-STD-105 - Sampling Procedures.
MIL-STD-129 - Marking for Shipment and Storage.

(Copies of Military Specifications and Standards required by suppliers in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

FSC 7210

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2.2 Other publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless a specific issue is identified, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

National Motor Freight Traffic Association, Inc., Agent:

National Motor Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Trucking Associations, Inc., Tariff Order Section, 1616 P Street, N.W., Washington, DC 20036.)

Uniform Classification Committee, Agent:

Uniform Freight Classification.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Uniform Classification Committee, Room 1106, 222 South Riverside Plaza, Chicago, IL 60606.)

American Society for Testing and Materials (ASTM) Standard:

E 162 - Surface Flammability of Materials Using a Radiant Heat Energy Source.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Society for Testing and Materials, 1916 Race St., Philadelphia, PA 19103.)

American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists (AATCC):

Appearance of Durable Press Fabrics after Repeated Home Launderings 124-1969.

(Applications for copies should be addressed to the American Association of Textile Chemist and Colorists, Research Triangle Park, P.O. Box 886, Durham, N.C. 27709.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Material.

3.1.1 Latex foam. The foam material for the outer envelope of the insert shall be made from polychloroprene latex foam. The cured foam shall consist of interconnecting cells, reasonably uniform in size and free from large internal voids perceptible on the exterior of the pillow by sight or touch. The cured foam shall conform to the physical requirements specified in table I when tested (except for odor) as specified in 4.3.1.1. Bonded shredded foam or loose foam will not be permitted.

TABLE I. Physical requirements of laxtex foam

Characteristic	Requirement
Permanent set (maximum per cent)	20
Resistance to flexing (250,000 cycles)	1/
Permanent set after flexing (maximum per cent)	10
Indentation (pounds to compress 25% of total thickness at 4" thick)	25 - 40
Indentation after accelerated aging (maximum per cent change)	20
Static fatigue	2/
Cement bond	3/
Odor	4/
Fire Resistance	5/

NOTES:

1/ The latex foam shall show no breakdown of the physical structure.
2/ The latex foam shall show no cracking at the folded edge.
3/ The bond shall be stronger than the adjoining foam when separated by hand. The seam shall be flexible and in accordance with acceptable standard commercial practice.
4/ The foam shall be free from any pronounced odor.
5/ 10 max. per ASTM E-162-75 using one inch hexagonal screen and material shall exhibit no running, dripping or melting.

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3.1.2 Fiberfill. The inner core of the insert shall consist of a first quality garnetted virgin polyester fiber batting that has been specifically designed as a filling material for sleep pillows. The polyester batting core material for each pillow insert shall weigh 17 ± 1 ounce.

3.1.3 Cover fabric material. At the option of the contractor, the fabric used for the pillow cover shall be of the types specified in 3.1.4 or 3.1.5. The fabric used to construct the pillow cover shall have a maximum average length of char or destroyed material of not more than 5-1/2 inches when tested in accordance with table VI.

3.1.4 Cotton sheeting. Cotton sheeting shall conform to Federal Specification CCC-C-432, type VII class 3 except the sheeting is required to pass fire retardant test in table VI. At the option of the manufacturer, the nonfibrous material and breaking strength may be tested before the fabric has been treated with a fire retardant finish.

3.1.5 Cotton sateen. Cotton sateen material shall be pre-shrunk and have a residual shrinkage of not more than 2 percent in either the warp or filling direction. After sizing and finishing, the nonfibrous material shall not exceed 5 percent, the ounces per square yard shall be a minimum of 6.2, and the minimum breaking strength shall be 55 pounds in the warp and 55 pounds in the filling direction. At the option of the manufacturer, the nonfibrous material and breaking strength may be tested before the fabric has been treated with a fire resistant finish. (See table VI.)

3.1.6 Thread. The thread shall be bleached cotton conforming to type 1A2, three ply, ticket number 70 of V-T-276.

3.1.7 Slide fastener. The slide fastener shall conform to type I, style 6, size L, short tab pull of V-F-106. The slide fastener chains shall be fabricated of aluminum conforming to 3.3.1 of V-F-106. The slide fastener shall not be more than 2 inches shorter than the width of the pillow cover.

3.2 Color. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.1), the color of the cover fabric thread and slide fastener tape shall be bleached white.

3.3 Construction. The pillow shall consist of a chloroprene foam envelope 1/2-inch thick and a polyfiber insert with a removable cotton fabric cover.

3.3.1 Stitches, seams and stitching. Stitches, seams and stitching shall conform to Fed. Std. No. 751. Skipped stitches or thread breaks (301 or 401 stitch types) shall be repaired using stitch type 301.

3.3.2 Insert. The insert shall consist of an envelope of latex foam as specified in 3.1.1 and an inner core of (Fiberfill) as specified in 3.1.2. The envelope shall be 1/2 ± 1/16 inches thick in all areas and sealed at the edges with a suitable adhesive. The inner core polyester batting shall be such to give the proper thickness and to give adequate fill out of the envelope without large voids especially at edges.

3.3.3 Cover. The cover shall be fabricated from one or two pieces of material specified in 3.1.4 or 3.1.5. The fabric shall be cut 1/2 inch longer and 1/2 inch wider than the finished cover dimension to provide a 1/4 inch seam allowance. The side or sides and end shall be sewn using stitch type 301 and seam type SSa-1. All sewing shall be done with 6 to 8 stitches per inch using the thread specified in 3.1.6. The slide fastener specified in 3.1.7, shall be sewn to the fabric in the widthwise direction of the open end using stitch type 401 and seam type SSb-1. One end of the identification label shall be securely stitched into the end opposite the end containing the slide fastener. When separate state label is legally required by the state in which the pillow is manufactured, the state label shall be securely stitched adjacent to and in the same seam as the identification label.

3.4 Size.

3.4.1 Insert. The minimum and maximum dimensions (before covering and packaging) of the insert shall conform to table II.

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TABLE II. Insert dimensions

	Dimensions, inches
Length	24-25
Width	16-17
Thickness (at center)	6.5-7.5

3.4.2 Cover. The minimum inside dimensions (between seams) of the cover shall conform to table III.

TABLE III. Cover dimensions

	Dimensions inches
Length	28
Width	20-3/4

3.5 Marking.

3.5.1 State labeling requirements. When required, each pillow shall have a label attached to conform with the legal requirements of the state in which it is manufactured. When allowed under state law, the information required under state regulations may be combined in the identification label.

3.5.2 Identification label. Each pillow shall have an identification label containing the following information printed in bold letters and numerals not less than 1/8 inch in height:

Nomenclature

Size Federal Stock Number

Contractor's name or trademark

Contract number and date

3.5.2.1 Label. The label shall conform to the requirements of type I, class 9 of DDD-L-20 and shall show fair or better colorfastness to accelerated laundering when tested as specified therein.

3.6 Workmanship. The finished pillow shall conform to the quality of product established by this specification and shall have no pronounced odor. The cover, with a smoothly operating slide fastener, shall fit neatly over the insert. The occurrence of defects shall not exceed the specified acceptable quality levels.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified in the contract or order, the supplier may use his own or any other facilities suitable for the performance of the inspection requirements specified herein, unless disapproved by the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Evidence of compliance. In lieu of using his own facilities, the contractor may submit a report of analysis of component materials from a laboratory acceptable to the Government, whether an independent test facility or the laboratory of the raw material supplier, as evidence of compliance with all test requirements in table IV and applicable test requirements in table VI. The report of analysis shall include, in addition to the actual test data, the manufacturer's name, name and address of the testing laboratory, date of test, and quantity of material represented by the test report. Where certificates of compliance or reports of analysis are submitted, the Government reserves the right to check test such items to determine the validity of the certificate or analysis.

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4.2 Sampling for inspection and acceptance. Sampling for inspection and acceptance shall be performed in accordance with the provisions set forth in MIL-STD-105, except where otherwise indicated.

4.3 Intermediate inspection.

4.3.1 Inspection of components. In addition to the quality assurance provisions provided, inspection and testing shall be performed on components and materials as required by this specification.

4.3.1.1 Testing of the polychloroprene latex foam. Testing of the polychloroprene latex foam shall be performed in accordance with table IV for the characteristics shown therein. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one latex foam slab with dimensions 1/2 x 17 x 52 inches. The sample unit shall be one latex foam slab with dimensions 4 x 18 x 55.5 inches. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any of the requirements specified.

TABLE IV. Instructions for testing polychloroprene latex foam material 4/

Characteristic	Specification requirement	Reference test method	Requirements applicable to Individual Unit	Number Determinations per Individual Unit	Results report Pass or Fail	Results report Numerically to Nearest
Permanent set	Table I	Method 12131 1/ Fed. Std. No. 601	X	1		1 percent
Resistance to flexing	Table I	Method 12111 Fed. Std. No. 601	X	1	X	
Permanent set after flexing	Table I	Method 12131 2/ Fed. Std. No. 601	X	1		1 percent
Indentation:						
Original	Table I	Method 12121 3/ Fed. Std. No. 601	X	1		0.5 percent
After accelerated aging	Table I	Para. 4.5.1 and Method 12121 2/ Fed. Std. No. 601	X	1		1 percent
Static fatigue	Table I	Para. 4.5.2	X	1	X	
Cement bond of insert (when applicable)	Table I	Std. Comm'l.	X	1	X	
Fire Resistance	Table I	ASTM E 162	X	1	X	Whole

1/ Except that specimen shall be exposed for a period of 22 hours in lieu of 46 hours.
2/ Except that the test specimen shall be in full thickness with minimum area dimension greater than the thickness.
3/ The test shall be conducted on the whole latex foam insert at the center.
4/ All tests in table IV, except cement bond of insert shall utilize four inch thick sample.

4.3.1.2 Dimensional examination of insert. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one completed insert. The inspection level shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105. The unit of product shall be one individual insert. The defects found during the examinations shall be classified in accordance with table V. The AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE V. Insert dimensional defects

Examine	Defect
Length	Less than specified
Width	Less than specified
Thickness	Less than specified

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4.3.1.3 Testing of covers. Testing shall be performed on the covers as listed in table VI. At the option of the manufacturer, the nonfibrous material and breaking strength may be tested before the fabric has been treated with a fire retardant finish and made into a cover. The sample unit for testing shall be one pillow cover, and the lot size shall be expressed in units of pillow covers. The sample size and the lot size shall be expressed in terms as shown in table VII. The lot shall be unacceptable if one or more sample units fail to meet any specified requirements. The method of testing specified in Federal Test Method Std. No. 191, wherever applicable, and as listed in table VI shall be followed.

TABLE VI. Testing of pillow cover L material

Component and lot size expressed in terms of:	Characteristic	Requirement paragraph	Test Method
Cotton sateen (sq. yd.)	Weight	3.1.5	5041 1/
	Breaking strength	3.1.5	5100 1/
	Shrinkage	3.1.5	5550 1/
	Nonfibrous material	3.1.5	2611 1/
	Flame-resistance	3.1.3	5903 2/
Cotton sheeting (sq. yd.) conforming to type VII, class 3 of CCC-C-432	Flame-resistance	3.1.3	5903 2/

1/ May be accepted based on contractor's certificate of compliance.
2/ The cloth shall pass this test after having been washed and dried 10 times according to the procedures described in Section 6.2 (III) and 6.3.2 B in the American Association of Textile Chemists and Colorists Test Method 124-1969. The cloth shall not continue flaming for more than two seconds after the flame is removed.

TABLE VII. Sample size

Lot size (units)	Sample size
800 or less	3
801 to 22,000	4
22,001 and over	5

4.4 Inspection of the end item.

4.4.1 Visual examination of the end item. The lot size shall be expressed in units of complete pillows. The inspection level for purposes of determining the sample size shall be I of MIL-STD-105. The unit of product shall be one complete pillow. The defects found during the examination shall be classified in accordance with table VIII. The AQL shall be 2.5 major defects and 6.5 total defects (major and minor combined) per hundred units.

TABLE VIII. Complete pillow defects

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Classification Minor
Cover	Hole, cut or tear.	X	
	Spot, stain, or streak clearly noticeable when viewed at a distance of 3 feet.		X
	Color not as specified.	X	
	Slide fastener not positioned as specified.	X	
	Slide fastener more than 2 inches shorter than width of pillow cover	X	
	Any cover face fabricated of more than one piece of fabric.	X	

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TABLE VIII. Complete pillow defects (con.)

Examine	Defect	Classification Major	Minor
Cover (con.)	Stitch type not as specified.	X	
	Seam type not as specified.		X
	Less stitches per inch than specified.		X
	More stitches per inch than specified.		X
	Any seam open more than 1 inch.	X	
	Any seam open more than 1/2 inch but less than 1 inch.		X
	Note: A seam shall be classified as open when one or more stitches joining a seam are broken or when 2 or more continuous skipped stitches or runoffs occur.		X
	Seam pleated or badly twisted.	X	
	Loose tension resulting in a loose seam.		X
	Tight tension (stitches break when normal strain is applied to stitching.)		X
	Needle chew.	X	
	Slide fastener not as specified.	X	
	Material not as specified.	X	
	Cover loose or puckered to an extent adversely affecting appearance.		X
Identification label	Missing, incorrect, text incomplete, illegible or insecurely attached.		X

4.4.1.1 Dimensional examination of cover. The lot size shall be expressed in units of one completed cover. The inspection level shall be S-3 of MIL-STD-105. The unit of product shall be one individual cover. The defects found during the examinations shall be classified in accordance with table IX. The AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

TABLE IX. Cover dimensional defects

Examine	Defect
Inside length (between seams)	Less than specified
Inside width (between seams)	Less than specified

4.4.2 Examination of preparation for delivery. An examination shall be made to determine that packaging, packing and marking requirements of section 5 of this specification are complied with. The lot size shall be the number of shipping containers in the end item inspection lot. The inspection level shall be S-2 of MIL-STD-105. The sample unit for these examinations shall be one shipping container fully prepared for delivery with the exception that it need not be sealed. Closed shipping containers shall be examined for closure defects. The defects found during the examinations shall be classified in accordance with table X. The AQL shall be 4.0 defects per hundred units.

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TABLE X. Preparation for delivery defects

Examine	Defect
Markings (exterior and interior)	Omitted; incorrect; illegible; or improper size, location, sequence, or method of application.
Materials	Any component missing or damaged.
Workmanship	Inadequate application of components such as incomplete closure of container flaps, loose strapping, inadequate stapling. Bulging or distortion of container.

4.5 Test Methods.

4.5.1 Accelerated aging. A specimen of latex foam at least 12 inches by 12 inches in full thickness shall be subjected to the air-heat test specified in method 7221 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601, except that the test shall be run for 22 hours at 212° ± 2° Fahrenheit.

4.5.2 Static fatigue. A specimen of latex foam 4 inches by 20 inches shall be bent parallel to the 4 inch dimension to an angle of 135° between two compression plates for 22 hours at 158° ± 2° Fahrenheit. The heat exposure shall be carried out in the apparatus described in method 7221 of Fed. Test Method Std. No. 601. The opening between the two plates should be equal to twice the thickness of the unfolded specimen. The folded edge of the specimen should not extend beyond the edges of the compression plate.

5. PREPARATION FOR DELIVERY

5.1 Packaging. Packaging shall be level A, B, or C as specified (see 6.1).

5.1.1 Level A. Each pillow shall be placed in a bag fabricated of polyethylene film of a 0.002-inch thickness conforming to type 1, grade A, B, or C, finish 1, of L-P-378. Excess air shall be removed from bags before complete closure is effected. All seams and closures shall be effected by heat sealing and shall conform to the heat seal strength requirement of L-P-378. Each bagged pillow shall be packaged in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class domestic. The fiberboard shall have a bursting strength of not less than 200 p.s.i. The box shall be closed and sealed in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.1.2 Level B. Each pillow shall be packaged in a bag fabricated of polyethylene film, 0.002 inch in thickness, conforming to type I, grade A, B or C, finish 1 of L-P-378. Excess air shall be removed from each bag before final closure. All seams and closures shall be made by heat sealing and shall conform to the heat seal strength requirements of L-P-378.

5.1.3 Level C. The pillows shall be packaged in accordance with standard industry practice.

5.2 Packing. Packing shall be level A, , or C as specified (see 6.2).

5.2.1 Level A. Twelve pillows of one type and size only, packaged as specified in 5.1, shall be packed flat in a box conforming to PPP-B-636, class weather resistant. Each box shall be closed, waterproof sealed, and strapped in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.2 Level B. Twelve pillows of one type and size shall be packed as specified in 5.2.1, except the box shall be class domestic. Closure shall be in accordance with the appendix to the box specification.

5.2.3 Level C. The pillows shall be packed to insure carrier acceptance and safe delivery to destination in containers complying with the Uniform Freight Classification rules or National Motor Freight Classification rules.

5.3 Marking.

5.3.1 Civil agencies. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with FED-STD-123.

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5.3.2 Military activities. In addition to markings required by the contract or order, the interior packages and shipping containers shall be marked in accordance with MIL-STD-129.

6. NOTES

6.1 Ordering data. Purchasers should select the preferred options permitted herein, and include the following information in procurement documents:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Color required, if other than bleached white (3.2).
(c) Selection of applicable levels of packaging and packing (5.1 and 5.2).

Preparing activity:

GSA-FSS

Civil Agency Coordinating Activity:

GSA-FSS

Orders for this publication are to be placed with General Services Administration, acting as an agent for the Superintendent of Documents. See Section 2 of this specification to obtain extra copies and other documents referenced herein. Price 35 cents each.

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